

Allegations Against Staff Procedure

SECTIONS 1-4: PURPOSE, SCOPE, RESPONSIBILITIES & REPORTING

1 PURPOSE

To ensure any allegation or concern about staff conduct is managed fairly, promptly and transparently to protect children and young people while upholding the rights of staff, in accordance with Children First, Tusla guidance and HIQA standards.

2 SCOPE

- ✓ **All allegations or concerns** about staff behaviour toward children
- ✓ **Staff, volunteers, agency workers** and contractors
- ✓ **Reporting, investigation, support** and learning processes
- ✓ **All locations and activities**

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Provider & PIC:** Immediate protective action and oversight
- ✓ **Designated Officer:** Manage the allegation process
- ✓ **Care Staff:** Report concerns without delay
- ✓ **Management:** Support all parties and liaise with agencies
- ✓ **All Staff:** Cooperate fully with investigations

4 REPORTING

- ✓ **Clear, accessible routes** for reporting concerns
- ✓ **Immediate notification** to PIC, Tusla and Gardaí when required
- ✓ **Child protection procedures** activated immediately
- ✓ **Confidentiality and support** for the person reporting
- ✓ **Accurate contemporaneous records** maintained

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SECTIONS 5-7: CHILD PROTECTION, INVESTIGATION & SUPPORT

5 CHILD PROTECTION

- ✓ Immediate steps to safeguard the child
- ✓ Medical and therapeutic support offered
- ✓ Views of the child listened to and recorded
- ✓ Family and placing authority informed appropriately
- ✓ Risk assessment updated

6 INVESTIGATION

- ✓ Fair and impartial investigation process
- ✓ Suspension or reassignment where necessary
- ✓ Full cooperation with external agencies
- ✓ Timelines for internal and external processes
- ✓ Support for the staff member (representative, welfare)

7 OUTCOMES & LEARNING

- ✓ Appropriate disciplinary or other action taken
- ✓ Lessons learned shared organisation-wide
- ✓ Policy and training updated if needed
- ✓ Feedback to relevant parties
- ✓ Record of outcome securely stored

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SECTIONS 8-10: TRAINING, MONITORING & POLICY REVIEW

8 TRAINING & COMPLIANCE

- ✓ All staff trained on this procedure
- ✓ Policy displayed and accessible
- ✓ Compliance monitored
- ✓ Immediate action on any breach of process
- ✓ Records compliant with GDPR

9 MONITORING & REVIEW

- ✓ Audits of allegation handling
- ✓ Feedback from all parties
- ✓ Trend analysis
- ✓ Effectiveness assessed
- ✓ Staff debrief and support reviewed

10 POLICY REVIEW

- ✓ Reviewed annually or sooner if required
- ✓ Incorporates lessons from cases and feedback
- ✓ Regulatory updates incorporated
- ✓ Approved by Registered Provider and communicated to all staff
- ✓ Superseded versions archived